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ZOHRAN MAMDANI MAKES HISTORY IN NEW YORK

■ New York mayor-elect Zohran Mamdani, second from right, stands on stage with his wife Rama Duwaji, second from left; father Mahmood Mamdani, left; and mother Mira Nair, after making an acceptance speech in New York on Tuesday. Mamdani's election capped a stunning ascent for the 34-year-old state lawmaker, who is set to become the city's first Muslim mayor and the most liberal in generations.

SEE ALSO P9

RTA announces new Dubai taxi fares, Dh13 minimum fare

Revised fares are for taxi bookings through smart apps

DUBAI
BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor

The Roads and Transport Authority announced revised fares for taxi booking through smart apps yesterday.

Under the new fare structure, the minimum taxi fare has been raised from Dh12 to Dh13. The authority has also introduced new peak-hour rates and booking fees, which vary depending on the day of the week.

From Monday to Thursday, a booking fee of Dh7.50 will apply during the peak hours of 8am to 9.59am and 4pm to 7.59pm. The flagfall fare during these periods will be Dh5.

During off-peak hours of 6am

Dh12

was the minimum taxi fare until now through smart apps

to 7.59am and 10am to 3.59pm, the booking fee will be Dh4, while the flagfall will be Dh5.

Night-hour fares will apply from 10pm until 5.59am. During this period, the booking fee will be Dh4.5, while the flagfall fare will be Dh5.50.

On Fridays, peak-hour fares will apply from 8am until 9.59am and 4pm until 7.59pm. During these periods, the booking fee will be Dh7.50 while the flagfall will be Dh5. From 10pm until 11.59pm, the booking fee will be Dh7.50, while the flagfall will be Dh5.50.

During off-peak hours of 6am until 7.59am and 10am until 3.59pm, a booking fee of Dh4 will apply, while flagfall will be Dh5.

A night-hour booking fee of Dh4.50 will apply from 12am until 5.59am, along with a flagfall of Dh5.50.

Peak-hour fee on weekends

On Saturdays and Sundays, peak-hour booking fee of Dh7.50 will apply from 4pm until 9.59pm (flagfall of Dh5), and 10pm until 11.59pm (flagfall of Dh5.50).

Off-peak rates will apply from 6am until 7.59am, 8am until 9.59am, and 10am until 3.59pm. During these periods, the booking fee will be Dh4, while the flagfall will be Dh5.

A night-hour booking fee of Dh4.50 and flagfall of Dh5.50 will be applicable from 12am until 5.59am.



SPORT

Why Gill does not deserve a place in India's T20 side

Conservative approach, failures add to chorus | P11

Dubai boy, 7, completes 2 Himalayan treks in a year

Tops Everest Base Camp, Annapurna Circuit

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

In a rare accomplishment, Ivan Krasiukov, a seven-year-old Grade 2 student at Bloom World Academy (BWA), has completed both the Everest Base Camp (5,364m) and Annapurna Circuit (Thorong La Pass, 5,416m) treks within a year.

His achievement was verified and formally recognised this month by Spain-headquartered Official World Record (OWR) Europe as the youngest person to complete both daunting treks.

In April 2024, then six years old, Ivan became one of the youngest children ever to complete the 130-km Everest Base Camp trek. In April 2025, he summited Thorong La Pass on the An-



napurna Circuit in Nepal — one of the highest walkable mountain passes on Earth. On both expeditions, Ivan was accompanied by his parents, Alla and Dmitrii Krasiukov.

"It was great to set out in the morning and start walking — we had a real team," Ivan said. He prepared for such challenges through regular athletics, swimming, parkour, and acrobatics training, building the strength, endurance and mindset needed for such extraordinary feats.

CBSE Global Curriculum in UAE schools

NEW CURRICULUM TO COME INTO FORCE GLOBALLY FROM APRIL 2026

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

106

CBSE schools in the UAE, its largest network outside India

In a historic move, India's Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) has announced plans to launch CBSE Global Curriculum from April 2026, which will be implemented across all CBSE-affiliated schools in the UAE and other foreign countries.

The announcement came during the first international and 31st annual conference of Sahodaya School Complexes which began in Dubai on Tuesday, marking a significant milestone in CBSE's journey towards becoming a truly global board. More than 800 CBSE school leaders and educationists from India and the Gulf attended the two-day event themed "Rooted in Wisdom, Rising with Vision — Reimagining Education through NEP 2020."

Constructive step

Senior regulators and officials from the GCC Ministries of Education, including Oman, Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, and the UAE — represented by Dubai's Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA), Abu Dhabi Department of Education and Knowledge (ADEK), and Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA) — held constructive discussions with senior functionaries from CBSE, the Government of India, and the Consul General of India in Dubai on the forthcoming

ing curriculum. In September this year, *Gulf News* had reported CBSE's plan to launch an international school in the UAE when Indian Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan announced that the board was planning to commission an international board during a press conference at the Indian Consulate in Dubai.

At the time, Pradhan said schools following that curriculum would open globally, including in the UAE. CBSE has now clarified that the new curriculum would be called the CBSE Global Curriculum.

Speaking to *Gulf News* yesterday, Dr Ram Shankar, director of CBSE Regional Office and Centre of Excellence in Dubai, clarified that the new curriculum is currently at the draft stage.

"We will have more discussions with the stakeholders for finalising the curriculum and it is likely to be rolled out next academic year," said Dr Ram, who oversees all foreign schools affiliated to CBSE. There are 106 CBSE schools in the UAE, making it the largest CBSE school network outside India.

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